

Figure 1: CloudBees EcoSystem

needed for application deployment, and it is easy to migrate applications to and from CloudBees.

Support for the development processes

CloudBees makes life easier for application developers, as it removes the overhead for application and resource management. It is not only a runtime environment, but also an integrated build, dev and test environment. Developers can use the Jenkins service to have CloudBees automatically and continuously check out, build, test and report code in the repository. CloudBees supports IDE tools, command-line

tools, Web-based consoles, Web access to logs, third-party development and testing services, and API access. On top of all these, good documentation is like chocolate topping on vanilla ice-cream.

Performance and scalability

One of the most important features of CloudBees, from the business perspective, is the platform's ability to auto-scale. CloudBees supports a built-in load balancer and the custom domains for it. Users can define performance criteria to measure load-balancing requirements and the auto-scaling of application servers is supported accordingly. Database scaling is not supported. It provides horizontal, vertical and auto-scaling features with Web-based monitoring dashboards.

Jenkins as a service

Jenkins is an open source continuous integration tool written in Java. It supports SCM tools including CVS, Subversion, Git, Mercurial, Perforce and ClearCase. In CloudBees, users can execute Apache Ant and Apache Maven-based projects.

Builds can be started by a commit in a version control system, scheduling via a cron-like mechanism, building when other builds have completed, and by requesting a specific build URL. Cron is a time-based job scheduler in UNIX-like computer operating systems that enables users to schedule jobs (commands or shell scripts) to run periodically at certain times or dates (see table below).

With the use of the CloudBees dashboard, users can manage and keep track of various builds.

Entry	Description	Equivalent To
@yearly	Run once a year, midnight, Jan. 1st	0 0 1 1 *
@monthly	Run once a month, midnight, first of month	0 0 1 * *
@weekly	Run once a week, midnight on Sunday	0 0 * * 0
@daily	Run once a day, midnight	0 0 * * *
@hourly	Run once an hour, beginning of hour	0 * * * *
@reboot	Run at start-up	

*	*	*	*	*
min (0 - 59)	hour (0 - 23)	day of month (1 - 31)	month (1 - 12)	day of week (0[SUN] - 6)

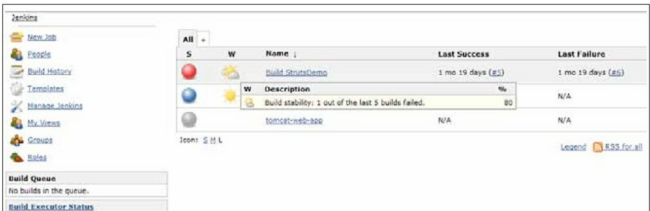


Figure 2: The CloudBees Dashboard—Jenkins